

Abi Sarasan

Senior IT Administrator · 12+ years GCC experience

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PROFILE

My core expertise spans Windows Server, Active Directory, Microsoft 365 and Exchange hybrid environments, Azure, and modern device management with Intune, backed by hands-on work in hybrid Entra ID architectures.

I am expanding into AI-driven automation, using n8n and Claude to streamline IT workflows, reduce manual overhead, and build smarter helpdesk and support systems. Combining traditional infrastructure strength with automation and AI is where I see enterprise IT heading.

KEY STRENGTHS

- **Enterprise vision:** aligning IT infrastructure, security and support with business goals
- **Hybrid identity and endpoint:** Entra ID, Intune, Conditional Access, Autopilot
- **Generative AI and Claude workloads:** running AI workloads and driving organisation-wide AI adoption for up to 20x faster work
- **Automation:** n8n and Claude workflows for ticket triage, onboarding and self-service
- **360° coverage:** identity, endpoints, cloud, network security, backup and ITSM

PHILOSOPHY

> *AI is not replacing IT professionals. It is replacing the ones who refuse to adapt.*

I am an advocate of AI and automation in IT. After 12+ years in enterprise IT, I believe the biggest gains come from letting automation handle the repeatable work and AI handle the reading, sorting and drafting, while people keep control of the decisions.

CORE SKILLS

Microsoft Intune · Entra ID · Microsoft 365 · Exchange Hybrid · Azure · Windows Server · Active Directory · Fortinet · Microsoft Defender · PowerShell · n8n · Claude · AWS · VMware · ManageEngine · Jira · ITIL

CERTIFIED SKILLS

Security: CompTIA Security+ · ISC2 Candidate · Fortinet NSE 1 Network Security

Cloud: AWS Solutions Architect · Azure Administrator · Oracle Cloud Infrastructure · Aviatrix Multi-Cloud Networking · Cloud Computing Foundation

Virtualization & DR: VMware VCP5 Data Center · VMware VCA Cloud · Zerto Disaster Recovery

Networking: Cisco CCNA · CompTIA Network+ (TCP/IP) · Fortinet Firewalls

Microsoft Platforms: MCITP Enterprise Administrator · MCTS · Teams Administrator · MD-101 Modern Desktop · Windows Server Group Policy · macOS for IT Admins

ITSM, Agile & AI: ITIL Foundation · Scrum Foundation · Introduction to AI Concepts

EXPERIENCE

Senior Information Technology Administrator Apr 2024 – Present

News Group International · Dubai, UAE · On-site

- Manage tickets in ManageEngine ServiceDesk Plus and Jira to strict SLAs following ITIL.
- Administer multi-site Windows Server, Active Directory, Entra ID, DNS and DHCP.
- Configure Fortinet firewalls (HA, VPN tunnels) and Microsoft Defender endpoint security.
- Lead Intune device management and oversee Microsoft 365 and Windows 365.
- Build AI and n8n workflows for early threat detection and faster incident response.

Lead Technical Specialist Oct 2022 – Mar 2024

F9 Infotech · UAE, India, Canada · On-site

- First technical hire: built the entire technical infrastructure from the ground up.
- Recruited and interviewed the IT team, then trained them into next-era IT engineers.
- Scaled IT to support company growth to ₹100 crore and expansion into new geographies (UAE, India, Canada).
- Delivered end-to-end cybersecurity operations and IT infrastructure security.
- Ran vulnerability assessments on websites and digital assets for proactive remediation.
- Automated security administration, reporting and threat hunting with PowerShell.
- Led patching, compliance audits and security documentation for audit readiness.

Information Technology Administrator Nov 2021 – Oct 2022

Syntrasol General Trading · United Arab Emirates

- Managed HP ProLiant servers: deployment, monitoring, patching and disaster recovery.
- Administered Office 365: Azure AD lifecycle, Exchange Online, Teams, SharePoint, OneDrive.
- Enforced mobile compliance with AirWatch (Workspace ONE) and ran tape backup workflows.

Information Technology Administrator Dec 2019 – Oct 2022

Lockton Middle East North Africa · Dubai, UAE · On-site

- Sole IT administrator across three sites (UAE, Jordan, Egypt), recognised as a vital worker during the pandemic.
- Managed Intune MDM, Microsoft 365, Azure AD and VMware, with AWS certification.
- Handled identity and access via ManageEngine AD Manager and monthly AD Audit reporting.

VDI Administrator Nov 2014 – Dec 2015

EZDC Automation · Chennai, India

- Services partner to VMware PSO (ASEAN) on pre- and post-sales engagements.
- Consulted on vSphere and Horizon View design, deployment and documentation.

FEATURED PROJECTS

- **SmartLedger** (AI-Powered Expense Automation): An AI workflow that extracts and validates receipt data into structured financial reports, cutting manual entry and improving accuracy.
- **Agentic Security Response** (n8n + Claude): A prototype that auto-classifies suspicious email and account activity, flags mailbox rule anomalies and drafts incident summaries to shrink time-to-containment.
- **Agentic Voice Agent** (Voice AI + n8n + Claude): A voice agent that answers calls, understands the request, takes action through n8n workflows such as logging a ticket or booking a callback, and hands over to a person when needed.
- **Office Replacement Project** (MGTI · Marsh McLennan Saudi): IT delivery for the office replacement project for Marsh McLennan Saudi through MGTI, covering the technology setup of the new office.
- **VMware Horizon VDI Delivery** (VMware PSO, ASEAN): Design, installation and configuration of Horizon View deployments (up to 100 desktops), including a Singapore petroleum client engagement.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA), Information Technology
Manipal International University · 2007 – 2009

Bachelor of Computer Application (BCA), Computer Science
Madurai Kamaraj University · 2000 – 2003

CERTIFICATIONS

- **CompTIA Security+**, CompTIA (Issued Nov 2024 · Expires Nov 2027)
- **Introduction to AI Concepts**, Microsoft Learn (Badge earned Jul 2026)
- **ITIL® Foundation Certificate in IT Service Management**, PeopleCert (Issued Nov 2014)
- **Microsoft Certified IT Professional (Enterprise Administrator)**, Microsoft (Issued Feb 2011)
- **Microsoft Certified Technology Specialist**, Microsoft (Issued Feb 2011)
- **VMware Certified Associate: VCA Cloud**, VMware (Issued Nov 2013)
- **VMware Certified Professional 5: Data Center Virtualization (VCP5)**, VMware (Issued Dec 2012)
- **Cloud Computing Foundation Certificate**, EXIN (Issued Jul 2012)
- **Zerto Certified Associate**, Zerto (HPE) (Issued Oct 2021)
- **Microsoft Managing Modern Desktop (MD-101) Cert Prep: Windows Deployment, Updates, and Policies**, LinkedIn Learning (Issued Jul 2022)
- **Windows Server 2022: Implementing Group Policy**, LinkedIn Learning (Issued Jun 2022)
- **macOS for IT Administrators**, LinkedIn Learning (Issued Nov 2021)
- **CompTIA Network+ (N10-007) Cert Prep: The World of TCP/IP**, LinkedIn Learning (Issued Aug 2021)
- **Tips for Writing Business Emails**, LinkedIn Learning (Issued Jul 2022)
- **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate**, Amazon Web Services (Issued Dec 2022 · Expired Dec 2025)
- **ISC2 Candidate**, ISC2 (Issued Feb 2025 · Expired Feb 2026)
- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure 2022 Certified Foundations Associate**, Oracle (Issued Feb 2023 · Expired Feb 2025)
- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate**, Microsoft (Issued Oct 2021 · Expired Oct 2023)
- **Microsoft 365 Certified: Teams Administrator Associate**, Microsoft (Issued Feb 2022 · Expired Feb 2023)
- **Fortinet Network Security Expert Level 1: Network Security Associate**, Fortinet (Issued Jun 2020 · Expired Jun 2022)
- **Aviatrix Certified Engineer: Multi-Cloud Network Associate**, Aviatrix (Issued Aug 2020 · Expired Aug 2023)
- **Scrum Foundation Professional Certificate**, Certiprof (Issued Sep 2020 · Expired Aug 2022)
- **Lifelong Learning**, Certiprof (Issued Jan 2021 · Expired Dec 2023)
- **Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA)**, Cisco (Issued Feb 2011 · Expired Feb 2014)